

salvation booklet

First Steps In a New Direction



Pastor Sean Pinder

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By Pastor Sean Pinder

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Welcome to the Family of God!

We welcome you into the family of God. This is the best decision you can make in your entire life: the decision to surrender your life to Jesus Christ. All of your sins have been completely forgiven.

Today marks the beginning of a new day and a new chapter in your life. The word of God tells us in 2 Corinthians 5:17, NLT: "This means that anyone who belongs to Christ has become a new person. The old life is gone; a new life has begun!" Isn't this great news? Yes, of course it is!

Now that you have become a child of God, I want to share some more exciting news with you. From the moment you accepted Jesus as your personal Lord and Savior, you received eternal life from Him. Listen to this amazing Scripture in John 5:24, NLT: "I tell you the truth, those who listen to my message and believe in God who sent me have eternal life. They will never be condemned for their sins, but they have already passed from death into life."

Read your Bible Daily.

As a new believer in the Lord Jesus, it is very important for you to read your Bible daily, beginning with the Gospel of John. The reason we read our Bible is because it's the Word of God, and it is what He uses to speak to us.

The Psalmist, David, says in Psalm 119:105, "Your word is a lamp to guide my feet and a light for my path." As you spend time reading the Scriptures, you will be amazed many times at how God will use them to encourage you.

There is nothing like reading a powerful verse of Scripture after having a tough day. It's like drinking a glass of ice water on a hot summer day in Texas. Another powerful Scripture came from Jesus Himself in Luke 4:4, KJVS: "And Jesus answered him, saying, It is written, That man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word of God."

Talk to God Daily (Pray).

How do we talk to God? God is real and He is always listening to you, especially when you

need to pour out your heart to Him. We talk to God by telling Him everything going on in our lives: things that have upset us or things that did not work out the way we were expecting them to. This is called prayer. We don't pretend when we go to God.

The Psalmist, David, is a perfect example of this in Psalm 61:2, NLT: "From the ends of the earth, I cry to you for help when my heart is overwhelmed. Lead me to the towering rock of safety..." And also, Jeremiah 33:3, TLB, says: "Ask me and I will tell you some remarkable secrets about what is going to happen here."

Join a Local Church.

Now that you are a believer in the Lord Jesus, you need to belong to a local body of believers for fellowship, teaching, and encouragement. You know the old saying, "No one man is an island."

You will be amazed at how God will use the local church to strengthen and uplift you in your new walk with the Lord. I have had this happen to me countless times. I was facing something in my life and, as the Pastor preached the Word, what he was saying was

almost as if he knew everything going on in my life. In moments like these, God is speaking through His servants to minister one-on-one to you.

The Scripture says in Hebrews 10:25, TLB, “Let us not neglect our church meetings, as some people do, but encourage and warn each other, especially now that the day of his coming back again is drawing near.”

God has designed the church for you to be a part of a spiritual family, worshipping God and growing together. Acts 5:42 says, “And daily in the temple, and in every house, they ceased not to teach and preach Jesus Christ.”

Ask God to Fill You With His Holy Spirit.

Now that you have given your life to Jesus, you need to ask Him to fill you with His Holy Spirit. In the book of Acts 1:8, NLT, it says, “But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes upon you. And you will be my witnesses, telling people about me everywhere—in Jerusalem, throughout Judea, in Samaria, and to the ends of the earth.”

Being filled with God's Spirit is when He gives you supernatural power to be a witness for Him as a new believer. We all desperately need this power at work in us to live effective lives for God. You cannot live this Christian life in your own strength; you need the power of God. This power is given to you by the Spirit of God.

Listen to what Jesus said about this in Luke 11:13, NLT: "So if you sinful people know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit to those who ask him." All you have to do is ask Him right now.

Tell others what Christ has done in you.

One of the greatest things you can do in your newfound faith is to share with your friends and loved ones what the Lord has done for you.

When I first gave my heart to Jesus on January 3, 1993, the first thing I did later that day was meet with my friends and tell them what had happened to me. Some of them

thought I was crazy. Others rejoiced for me because they knew my life seriously needed a change in direction.

Of course, it may seem harder with some to share your faith, but the Lord will give you the courage to do it. Sharing your faith with friends is like learning to ride a bicycle: the more you do it, the easier it becomes.

In the book of Mark 5:19, NLT, we read, “But Jesus said, “No, go home to your family, and tell them everything the Lord has done for you and how merciful he has been.”

What happens if you make a mistake?

As a new believer, remember that you *will* make mistakes. It’s like a child learning to walk who slips and falls but gets back up and keeps on going.

If you make a mistake or do something that is not Christ-like, you need to be quick to ask God to forgive you and He will, immediately. 1 John 1:9, NLT, says, “But if we confess our sins to him, he is faithful and just to forgive us

our sins and to cleanse us from all wickedness.”

Again, Pastor Aimee and I say a big congratulations to you, and we welcome you into the family of God.

Sincerely,
Pastors Sean and Aimee Pinder



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about



Pastors Sean & Aimee Pinder are a dynamic team that shakes nations and continually blesses God's people through anointed preaching of the strong, uncompromised Gospel followed by a demonstration of God's saving, healing, and miraculous power.

contact

- **PHONE:** 469-814-8215
- **EMAIL:** info@seanpinder.net
- **MAIL:** P.O. Box 2726 McKinney, TX 75070

connect

- ▶ @pastorseanpinder
- ▶ @seanpinderministries
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- ▶ @seanpindermin
- ▶ @seanpinderministries

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